Supplemental Data B: Search Strategy

Date of database search: 13.11.2019

MEDLINE

Search	Query	Hits
#1	back pain[MeSH Terms] OR low back pain[MeSH Terms] OR back pain*[Title/Abstract] OR lumb* pain[Title/Abstract] OR lumbago[Title/Abstract] OR backache*[Title/Abstract] OR back ache*[Title/Abstract] OR spinal stenosis[Title/Abstract] OR canal stenosis[Title/Abstract] OR lumbar stenosis[Title/Abstract] OR lateral stenosis[Title/Abstract] OR foramin stenosis[Title/Abstract] OR neurogenic claudication[Title/Abstract] OR radiculopathy[Title/Abstract] OR radicular pain[Title/Abstract] OR spondylolisthesis[Title/Abstract] OR spondylosis[Title/Abstract] OR sciatica[Title/Abstract] OR intervertebral disc displacement[Title/Abstract] OR referred pain[Title/Abstract] OR spinal nerve roots[Title/Abstract] OR neurologic signs[Title/Abstract] OR radiat* pain[Title/Abstract] OR radiat* symptoms[Title/Abstract] OR parathesia[Title/Abstract] OR numbness[Title/Abstract]	131336
#2	randomized[Title/Abstract] OR placebo[Title/Abstract] OR randomly[Title/Abstract] OR "drug therapy"[Title/Abstract] OR trial[Title/Abstract] OR groups[Title/Abstract]	2868072
#3	(animals[MeSH] NOT humans[MeSH]))	4659784
#4	#1 AND #2	25960
#5	#4 NOT #3	24928
#6	#5 AND Filters: Randomized Controlled Trial; Clinical Trial; Humans	7237

SPORTDiscus

Search	Query	Hits
#1	(DE "lumbar pain") OR (DE backache) OR (TI ("back pain*" OR "lumb* pain" OR lumbago OR backache* OR "back ache*" OR spinal stenosis OR canal stenosis OR lumbar stenosis OR lateral stenosis OR foramin stenosis OR neurogenic claudication OR radiculopathy OR radicular pain OR spondylolisthesis OR spondylosis OR sciatica OR intervertebral disc displacement OR referred pain OR spinal nerve roots OR neurologic signs OR radiat* pain OR radiat* symptoms OR parathesia OR numbness) OR AB ("back pain*" OR "lumb* pain" OR lumbago OR backache* OR "back ache*" OR spinal stenosis OR canal stenosis OR lumbar stenosis OR lateral stenosis OR foramin stenosis OR neurogenic claudication OR radiculopathy OR radicular pain OR spondylolisthesis OR spondylosis OR sciatica OR intervertebral disc displacement OR referred pain OR spinal nerve roots OR neurologic signs OR radiat* pain OR radiat* symptoms OR parathesia OR numbness))	11187
#2	TI (randomized OR placebo OR randomly OR "drug therapy" OR trial OR groups) OR AB (randomized OR placebo OR randomly OR "drug therapy" OR trial OR groups)	197381
#4	#1 AND #2	2970

CINAHL

Search	Query	Hits
#1	(MH low back pain) OR (MH back pain) OR (TI ("back pain*" OR "lumb* pain" OR lumbago OR backache* OR "back ache*" OR spinal stenosis OR canal stenosis OR lumbar stenosis OR lateral stenosis OR foramin stenosis OR neurogenic claudication OR radiculopathy OR radicular pain OR spondylolisthesis OR spondylosis OR sciatica OR intervertebral disc displacement OR referred pain OR spinal nerve roots OR neurologic signs OR radiat* pain OR radiat* symptoms OR parathesia OR numbness) OR AB ("back pain*" OR "lumb* pain" OR lumbago OR backache* OR "back ache*" OR spinal stenosis OR canal stenosis OR lumbar stenosis OR lateral stenosis OR foramin stenosis OR neurogenic claudication OR radiculopathy OR radicular pain OR spondylolisthesis OR spondylosis OR sciatica OR intervertebral disc displacement OR referred pain OR spinal nerve roots OR neurologic signs OR radiat* pain OR radiat* symptoms OR parathesia OR numbness))	45198
#2	TI (randomized OR placebo OR randomly OR "drug therapy" OR trial OR groups) OR AB (randomized OR placebo OR randomly OR "drug therapy" OR trial OR groups)	889333
#3	MH animals NOT MH human	74138
#4	#1 AND #2	11513
#5	#4 NOT #3	11461
#4	#5 AND Filters: Exclude MEDLINE records; Human; Randomized Controlled Trial	1335

PsycINFO

Search	Query	Hits
#1	(MA low back pain) OR (MA back pain) OR (TI ("back pain*" OR "lumb* pain" OR lumbago OR backache* OR "back ache*" OR spinal stenosis OR canal stenosis OR lumbar stenosis OR lateral stenosis OR foramin stenosis OR neurogenic claudication OR radiculopathy OR radicular pain OR spondylolisthesis OR spondylosis OR sciatica OR intervertebral disc displacement OR referred pain OR spinal nerve roots OR neurologic signs OR radiat* pain OR radiat* symptoms OR parathesia OR numbness) OR AB ("back pain*" OR "lumb* pain" OR lumbago OR backache* OR "back ache*" OR spinal stenosis OR canal stenosis OR lumbar stenosis OR lateral stenosis OR foramin stenosis OR neurogenic claudication OR radiculopathy OR radicular pain OR spondylolisthesis OR spondylosis OR sciatica OR intervertebral disc displacement OR referred pain OR spinal nerve roots OR neurologic signs OR radiat* pain OR radiat* symptoms OR parathesia OR numbness))	8813
#2	TI (randomized OR placebo OR randomly OR "drug therapy" OR trial OR groups) OR AB (randomized OR placebo OR randomly OR "drug therapy" OR trial OR groups)	1030813
#3	MA animals NOT MA human	196321
#4	#1 AND #2	2829

#5	#4 NOT #3	2809
#6	#5 AND Filters: Human; Journal Article	2377

EMBASE

Search	Query	Hits
#1	'low back pain'/exp OR 'backache'/exp OR 'back pain*':ab,ti OR 'lumb* pain':ab,ti OR lumbago:ab,ti OR backache*:ab,ti OR 'back ache*':ab,ti OR 'spinal stenosis':ab,ti OR 'canal stenosis':ab,ti OR 'lumbar stenosis':ab,ti OR 'lateral stenosis':ab,ti OR 'foramin stenosis':ab,ti OR 'neurogenic claudication':ab,ti OR radiculopathy:ab,ti OR 'radicular pain':ab,ti OR spondylolisthesis:ab,ti OR spondylosis:ab,ti OR sciatica:ab,ti OR 'intervertebral disc displacement':ab,ti OR 'referred pain':ab,ti OR 'spinal nerve roots':ab,ti OR 'neurologic signs':ab,ti OR 'radiat* pain':ab,ti OR 'radiat* symptoms':ab,ti OR parathesia:ab,ti OR numbness:ab,ti	161402
#2	randomized:ab,ti OR placebo:ab,ti OR randomly:ab,ti OR “drug therapy”:ab,ti OR trial:ab,ti OR groups:ab,ti	3957907
#3	'animal'/exp NOT 'human'/exp	5386039
#4	#1 AND #2	33606
#5	#4 NOT #3	32975
#6	#5 AND Filters: Controlled Clinical Trial; Randomized Controlled Trial; Exclude MEDLINE	2627

CENTRAL

Search	Query	Hits
#1	(MeSH descriptor: [back pain] explode all trees) OR (MeSH descriptor: [low back pain] explode all trees) OR (“back pain*” OR “lumb* pain” OR lumbago OR backache* OR “back ache*” OR spinal stenosis OR canal stenosis OR lumbar stenosis OR lateral stenosis OR foramin stenosis OR neurogenic claudication OR radiculopathy OR radicular pain OR spondylolisthesis OR spondylosis OR sciatica OR intervertebral disc displacement OR referred pain OR spinal nerve roots OR neurologic signs OR radiat* pain OR radiat* symptoms OR parathesia OR numbness):ti,ab,kw	3401
#2	(randomized OR placebo OR randomly OR "drug therapy" OR trial OR groups):ti,ab,kw	1204707
#3	#1 AND #2	2895
#4	(MeSH descriptor: [Animals] explode all trees) NOT (MeSH descriptor: [Humans] explode all trees)	7286
#5	#4 NOT #3	2893
#6	#5 AND Filters: Exclude MEDLINE; Exclude EMBASE; Trials	456

TOTAL from data base searches (with duplicates): 17002

Date of database search: 24/07/2020

MEDLINE

Search	Query	Hits
#1	back pain[MeSH Terms] OR low back pain[MeSH Terms] OR sciatica[MeSH Terms] OR back pain*[Title/Abstract] OR lumb* pain[Title/Abstract] OR lumbago[Title/Abstract] OR backache*[Title/Abstract] OR back ache*[Title/Abstract] OR spinal stenosis[Title/Abstract] OR canal stenosis[Title/Abstract] OR lumbar stenosis[Title/Abstract] OR lateral stenosis[Title/Abstract] OR foramin stenosis[Title/Abstract] OR neurogenic claudication[Title/Abstract] OR radiculopathy[Title/Abstract] OR radicular pain[Title/Abstract] OR spondylolisthesis[Title/Abstract] OR spondylosis[Title/Abstract] OR sciatica[Title/Abstract] OR intervertebral disc displacement[Title/Abstract] OR referred pain[Title/Abstract] OR spinal nerve roots[Title/Abstract] OR neurologic signs[Title/Abstract] OR radiat* pain[Title/Abstract] OR radiat* symptoms[Title/Abstract] OR paresthesia[Title/Abstract] OR paraesthesia[Title/Abstract] OR numbness[Title/Abstract]	141,803
#2	randomized[Title/Abstract] OR placebo[Title/Abstract] OR randomly[Title/Abstract] OR "drug therapy"[Title/Abstract] OR trial[Title/Abstract] OR groups[Title/Abstract]	2972235
#3	animals[MeSH] NOT humans[MeSH]	4720975
#4	#1 AND #2	28330
#5	#4 NOT #3	27250
#6	#5 AND Filters: Randomized Controlled Trial; Clinical Trial; Humans	9188

SPORTDiscus

Search	Query	Hits
#1	(DE "lumbar pain") OR (DE backache) OR (DE sciatica) OR (TI ("back pain*" OR "lumb* pain" OR lumbago OR backache* OR "back ache*" OR spinal stenosis OR canal stenosis OR lumbar stenosis OR lateral stenosis OR foramin stenosis OR neurogenic claudication OR radiculopathy OR radicular pain OR spondylolisthesis OR spondylosis OR sciatica OR intervertebral disc displacement OR referred pain OR spinal nerve roots OR neurologic signs OR radiat* pain OR radiat* symptoms OR paresthesia OR paraesthesia OR numbness) OR AB ("back pain*" OR "lumb* pain" OR lumbago OR backache* OR "back ache*" OR spinal stenosis OR canal stenosis OR lumbar stenosis OR lateral stenosis OR foramin stenosis OR neurogenic claudication OR radiculopathy OR radicular pain OR spondylolisthesis OR spondylosis OR sciatica OR intervertebral disc displacement OR referred pain OR spinal nerve roots OR neurologic signs OR radiat* pain OR radiat* symptoms OR paresthesia OR paraesthesia OR numbness))	14,427
#2	TI (randomized OR placebo OR randomly OR "drug therapy" OR trial OR groups) OR AB (randomized OR placebo OR randomly OR "drug therapy" OR trial OR groups)	237964
#4	#1 AND #2	4142

CINAHL

Search	Query	Hits
#1	(MH low back pain) OR (MH back pain) OR (MH sciatica) OR (TI (“back pain*” OR “lumb* pain” OR lumbago OR backache* OR “back ache*” OR spinal stenosis OR canal stenosis OR lumbar stenosis OR lateral stenosis OR foramin stenosis OR neurogenic claudication OR radiculopathy OR radicular pain OR spondylolisthesis OR spondylosis OR sciatica OR intervertebral disc displacement OR referred pain OR spinal nerve roots OR neurologic signs OR radiat* pain OR radiat* symptoms OR paresthesia OR paraesthesia OR numbness) OR AB (“back pain*” OR “lumb* pain” OR lumbago OR backache* OR “back ache*” OR spinal stenosis OR canal stenosis OR lumbar stenosis OR lateral stenosis OR foramin stenosis OR neurogenic claudication OR radiculopathy OR radicular pain OR spondylolisthesis OR spondylosis OR sciatica OR intervertebral disc displacement OR referred pain OR spinal nerve roots OR neurologic signs OR radiat* pain OR radiat* symptoms OR paresthesia OR paraesthesia OR numbness))	52162
#2	TI (randomized OR placebo OR randomly OR "drug therapy" OR trial OR groups) OR AB (randomized OR placebo OR randomly OR "drug therapy" OR trial OR groups)	997530
#3	MH animals NOT MH human	79989
#4	#1 AND #2	13351
#5	#4 NOT #3	13289
#4	#5 AND Filters: Exclude MEDLINE records; Human; Randomized Controlled Trial	699

PsycINFO

Search	Query	Hits
#1	(MA low back pain) OR (MA back pain) OR (MA sciatica) OR (TI (“back pain*” OR “lumb* pain” OR lumbago OR backache* OR “back ache*” OR spinal stenosis OR canal stenosis OR lumbar stenosis OR lateral stenosis OR foramin stenosis OR neurogenic claudication OR radiculopathy OR radicular pain OR spondylolisthesis OR spondylosis OR sciatica OR intervertebral disc displacement OR referred pain OR spinal nerve roots OR neurologic signs OR radiat* pain OR radiat* symptoms OR paresthesia OR paraesthesia OR numbness) OR AB (“back pain*” OR “lumb* pain” OR lumbago OR backache* OR “back ache*” OR spinal stenosis OR canal stenosis OR lumbar stenosis OR lateral stenosis OR foramin stenosis OR neurogenic claudication OR radiculopathy OR radicular pain OR spondylolisthesis OR spondylosis OR sciatica OR intervertebral disc displacement OR referred pain OR spinal nerve roots OR neurologic signs OR radiat* pain OR radiat* symptoms OR paresthesia OR paraesthesia OR numbness))	9726
#2	TI (randomized OR placebo OR randomly OR "drug therapy" OR trial OR groups) OR AB (randomized OR placebo OR randomly OR "drug therapy" OR trial OR groups)	1055873
#3	MA animals NOT MA human	197309
#4	#1 AND #2	3091

#5	#4 NOT #3	3070
#6	#5 AND Filters: Human; Journal Article	2628

EMBASE

Search	Query	Hits
#1	'low back pain'/exp OR 'backache'/exp OR 'sciatica'/exp OR 'back pain*':ab,ti OR 'lumb* pain':ab,ti OR lumbago:ab,ti OR backache*:ab,ti OR 'back ache*':ab,ti OR 'spinal stenosis':ab,ti OR 'canal stenosis':ab,ti OR 'lumbar stenosis':ab,ti OR 'lateral stenosis':ab,ti OR 'foramin stenosis':ab,ti OR 'neurogenic claudication':ab,ti OR radiculopathy:ab,ti OR 'radicular pain':ab,ti OR spondylolisthesis:ab,ti OR spondylosis:ab,ti OR sciatica:ab,ti OR 'intervertebral disc displacement':ab,ti OR 'referred pain':ab,ti OR 'spinal nerve roots':ab,ti OR 'neurologic signs':ab,ti OR 'radiat* pain':ab,ti OR 'radiat* symptoms':ab,ti OR paresthesia:ab,ti OR paraesthesia:ab,ti OR numbness:ab,ti	176118
#2	randomized:ab,ti OR placebo:ab,ti OR randomly:ab,ti OR "drug therapy":ab,ti OR trial:ab,ti OR groups:ab,ti	4102141
#3	'animal'/exp NOT 'human'/exp	5464750
#4	#1 AND #2	37042
#5	#4 NOT #3	36356
#6	#5 AND Filters: Controlled Clinical Trial; Randomized Controlled Trial; Exclude MEDLINE	2718

CENTRAL

Search	Query	Hits
#1	(MeSH descriptor: [back pain] explode all trees) OR (MeSH descriptor: [low back pain] explode all trees) OR (MeSH descriptor: [sciatica] explode all trees) OR ("back pain*" OR "lumb* pain" OR lumbago OR backache* OR "back ache*" OR spinal stenosis OR canal stenosis OR lumbar stenosis OR lateral stenosis OR foramin stenosis OR neurogenic claudication OR radiculopathy OR radicular pain OR spondylolisthesis OR spondylosis OR sciatica OR intervertebral disc displacement OR referred pain OR spinal nerve roots OR neurologic signs OR radiat* pain OR radiat* symptoms OR paresthesia OR paraesthesia OR numbness):ti,ab,kw (Word variations have been searched):ti,ab,kw	23060
#2	(randomized OR placebo OR randomly OR "drug therapy" OR trial OR groups):ti,ab,kw	1228587
#3	(MeSH descriptor: [Animals] explode all trees) NOT (MeSH descriptor: [Humans] explode all trees)	606
#4	#1 AND #2	19342
#5	#4 NOT #3	19340
#6	#5 AND Filters: Exclude MEDLINE; Exclude EMBASE; Trials	1258

TOTAL from data base searches (with duplicates): 20633
TOTAL from prior systematic reviews (with duplicates): 1783

TOTAL from reference lists of 17 relevant Cochrane reviews not included in reviews from last 10 years: 663
Duplicates removed (by Covidence): 3557
TOTAL for screening: 19522